

Elia Gasparolo – *Transitar lo Inaprensible*

By María Carolina Baulo

Having explored different disciplines within the visual arts, the work of Elia Gasparolo, an Argentine artist originally from the province of Mendoza, is currently situated within a multidisciplinary practice. Alongside painting, she creates soft-structured objects, garments, and accessories that form biotextiles, in which organic materiality itself takes center stage.

Her practice also encompasses a wide range of site-specific projects, both nationally and internationally. One particularly compelling characteristic of her work is her collaborative approach: she conceives her projects as works in progress that unfold over time, combining skills and knowledge with other artists working across different fields. These collaborations often connect her work with performance, video, and photography as means of documenting creative processes.

With a clear awareness of the transience of all things, her artistic gaze focuses on emphasizing the ephemeral and elusive nature of relationships. This is expressed through the materials she uses to create works that recount a unique and unrepeatable moment—one that reveals itself through matter and through its encounter with the viewer.

María Carolina Baulo: Your work moves from the plane into space: actions, performance, site-specific projects, photography, drawing, painting, objects, and bio-art. Tell us how these different artistic manifestations come together in your work and how they connect with one another.

Elia Gasparolo:

MCB: Let's begin with your most recent works, which started in 2020 and provide plenty of material to explore. I'm referring to *Tejido Conectivo – Biotextiles*. Tell us about the materials you use, how you choose them, and how you treat them. There is, of course, a very interesting conceptual framework underlying this work as well, and I would love for you to share it.

EG:

MCB: *Destellos de la Naturaleza* (2018), created together with Joaquín Fargas, is an interesting work produced in the context of a residency in the province of Catamarca, Argentina. The dialogue with the environment, and the choice of installation as a means of bringing the natural world into confrontation with robotics, lay the foundations for the works that would follow. Tell us about this particular project and about the collaborative process, which has remained a defining characteristic of your site-specific practice.

EG:

MCB: Since we have touched on the subject of site-specific work, I would like to know what you find so compelling about this format. I imagine it has much to do with the concepts of the elusive, the ephemeral, and the fleeting that run throughout your work.

Your work *El Futuro es Prehistoria* (2020–2021) is a site-specific project developed together with the artist Santiago Rey during the SACO Residency in Antofagasta, Chile. The project began in 2020 and involved a vast number of stages in its production and development. As I understand it, the installations will undergo mutations over time, requiring a yearly visit for their production and the step-by-step documentation of the process. Tell us more about it.

EG:

MCB: Another site-specific project is *Intocable* (2020), in which you participated by creating six aluminum mosquitoes for the retrospective exhibition of artist Gaspar Libedinsky at the Museo Nacional de Arte Decorativo in Buenos Aires in 2022. It is an aluminum installation with steel cables, with the mosquitoes—the insects—functioning as a kind of automatons.

Beyond the significance of this work itself, I would like to know what challenges the context presented, since it is very different from working outdoors. The circulation of the viewer is radically different, and consequently so is their relationship and interaction with the work. Tell us about these differences in relation to space and the viewer.

EG:

MCB: *Paisajes Posibles* (2021) is your latest site-specific intervention, created in Entre Ríos, Argentina, together with the artist Guillermo Vezzosi. It consisted of a kind of mantle made from aluminum pieces spread across an outdoor space, generating a new topography.

EG:

MCB: *Biotextiles* and site-specific projects seem to be the forms through which you are best able to channel your creative inquiries. How do you envision the immediate future of your practice?

EG:

Links: <https://eliagasparolo.com/>